



## Happy b'day, Tetris!

Tetris turns 30 on 6 June. Created by Alexey Pajitnov, the game was first released in 1984



## Protests against Twitter

Greenpeace protested outside Twitter's corporate headquarters in the hope of a commitment from the company to go green <http://dgit.in/11MJP3k>

Feature

## Microsoft abandons Windows 8.1

Yes, you read that correctly. Microsoft's way of ensuring that everyone on Windows 8.1 upgrades to the newest release is by cutting off support for Windows 8.1. Starting May 13th, 2014, Windows 8.1 will no longer receive updates or patches from Microsoft. Yes, Update 1 is a free upgrade, and yes, it offers substantial improvements, but we believe this policy will probably hurt consumers rather than help them. Companies that have business critical software running on Windows 8.1 will need time to test for compatibility before they take the leap. While Update 1 doesn't introduce any radical changes on the kernel or system level, system administrators will be (understandably) hesitant to take a risk. Microsoft's upgrade window of four weeks is too short a timeframe, and cutting off support at a time when security vulnerabilities like Heartbleed are making the news may not be the best move. In fact, servers running Windows 8.1 have been asked by Microsoft to hold off from updating as a bug in the newest release prevents WSUS 3.2 (Windows Server Update Services) from working over SSL, and the process fails. Microsoft is working on a fix, of course, but this appears to be highly irresponsible behaviour from Microsoft. For more information about this vulnerability and possible workarounds, visit <http://dgit.in/WSUS32>

when we couldn't figure it out on the first try, but it turns out we weren't the only ones. If your mouse pointer lingered on one of the right-hand side corners, (such as while closing a window or going back to the desktop) you'd end up activating one of the 'hot corners' that would bring up the Charms menu. This housed shortcuts to Search, Settings, Devices and a Share option, which might have been useful on a tablet, but was downright annoying on a desktop.



Windows 8 apps now have a title bar to quickly minimise or close apps

The resulting outcry over Windows 8 was pretty loud – some compared it to Windows Vista while others said they preferred DOS (no, really). Microsoft was listening, so they tried to address some of users' woes in the next point release. Windows 8.1 included a Start button, but this was a case of treating the symptom rather than the cause. Clicking on this new Start button would bring you back to the abomination that was the Start screen, so a real Start menu was still lacking. One notable improvement, though, was that Windows now included an option to boot straight to the desktop, if you'd rather avoid the Start screen. This, coupled with one of the many third-party replacements for the Start menu meant that Windows 8.1 was now usable again.

## Windows 8.1 Update 1

Windows' newest 8.1 iteration, Update 1, improves on the operating system's attempt at making Windows 8 usable by adding many subtle features and

enhancements, many of which are aimed at desktop users. Announced at Microsoft's Build 2014 conference, Windows 8.1 Update 1 (can we just call it Windows 8.1.1 already?) brings the much needed improvements for mouse and keyboard-driven interaction on the Start screen. Scrolling through the list of tiles is easier and feels more natural, and the size of the app icons in the app list can be made smaller to accommodate more of them on a large desktop display. The full-screen Windows 8 apps can now be pinned to the Windows taskbar, which is now ever present (it auto-hides if you're using a full screen app). Modern app also has a title bar which lets you conveniently minimise or close an app without hunting around for the right gesture. For those of you who



Right-clicking on a tile brings up a handy contextual menu

spend a lot of time on the Start screen (if you're using a touch-enabled laptop, for instance) you'll be pleased to find a power button and a search button on the Start screen with this update.

What really caught our attention with this update, though, is that Windows has become much smarter and more responsive. It recognises the type of device it's running on – desktop PC, server, tablet or



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